INCH-POUND
A-A-962A
November 29, 1994
SUPERSEDING
A-A-962
February 21, 1984

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

SHEARS; PRUNING, HAND (ONE HAND OPERATED)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description (CID) as a replacement for type I, grade A, size 9 and type 11, grade B, size 8 of GGG-S-284 for all federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This commercial item description covers pruning shears operated by one hand, suitable for pruning shrubbery.

2. CLASSIFICATION

2.1 Classification. The shears shall be of the following types, as specified (see 7.2):

Type I - Hook jaws

Type II - Straight jaws with blade and anvil

3. SALIENT CHARACTERISTICS

3.1 Blade. The cutting blade shall be manufactured from high carbon or alloy steel which has been heat treated to a Rockwell C hardness of 40 to 55 when tested in accordance with ASTM E18. The cutting blade shall be designed to prevent vegetation debris buildup between the hook and blade or anvil and blade which will cause interference in the operation of the shears. Cutting edges shall have a ground and polished keen cutting edge free of nicks, and shall be capable of being resharpened. A notched edge, designed to hold branches, may be provided at the manufacturer's option.

Beneficial comments, recommendations, additions, deletions, clarifications, etc. and any data which may improve this document should be sent to: General Services Administration, Engineering Group (7FXEE), 819 Taylor St., Fort Worth, TX 76102

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3.2 Pivot fastener. The pivot fastener shall provide tension on the blades to maintain proper alignment during the cutting action and shall not loosen during operation.

3.3 Spring. A tempered and durable steel spring having a corrosion resistant finish shall be provided. The spring shall rapidly open the shears from the fully closed to the fully opened position when either handle is released. With the shears in the fully opened position, the spring shall maintain sufficient tension against the handles to be retained in the shears.

3.4 Latch. The shears shall be provided with a latching device capable of locking the shears in the closed position. The design of the latch shall allow the latch to be set and released by the action of the same hand holding the shears.

3.5 Grips. Metal shear handles shall be covered with a cushioning material of rubber, vinyl, or other commercially used material to provide a smooth, comfortable gripping area. The grips shall be glued, bonded, or otherwise permanently attached to the handles.

3.6 The I - Hook jaws. Type I shears shall consist of a concave hook and a convex cutting blade and shall be similar in design to Figure 1. The minimum overall length of type I shears shall be 8 inches (20.3 cm). The handles shall be manufactured from either malleable iron, forged steel, or forged aluminum.

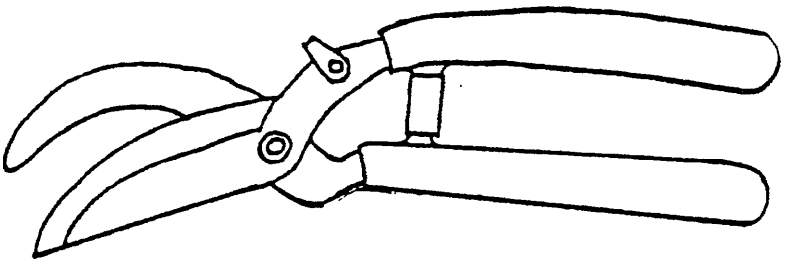


Figure 1 - Type I, Hook jaw pruning shears

3.7 Type II - Straight jaws with anvil. Type II shears shall consist of a straight cutting blade and a flat or grooved anvil design. Type II shears shall be similar in design to Figure 2. The minimum overall length of type II shears shall be 7 inches (17.8 cm). The handles shall be manufactured from stamped or forged steel, or forged aluminum. The type II shears shall have a replaceable anvil. Bolting or riveting the anvil in place is acceptable. The anvil shall be constructed from aluminum, brass, or bronze. The anvil shall extend the full length of the cutting blade. As an alternative design, the shears may be a ratchet-cut design with fiberglass reinforced plastic handles.

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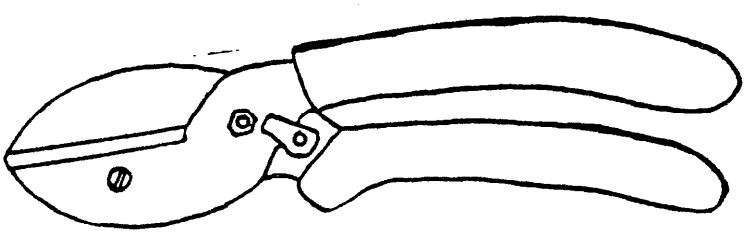


Figure 2 - Type II, Straight jaw pruning shears

3.8 Operation. The pruning shears shall be designed for one hand operation. Operation of the shears in the cutting or latching action shall not pose a hazard to the operator.

3.9 Finish. Metal components of the shears shall have a permanently applied corrosion resistant finish. The finish may be either chrome plating, polytetrafluoroethylene coating, or similar finish to prevent corrosion and debris build-up. The sharpened edge of the blades shall not be coated.

3.10 Performance. The shears shall be capable of cleanly cutting, one at a time, ten branches of green hardwood with a minimum cross section diameter of 5/16 inch (0.8 cm) . The ten cuts shall be accomplished with force applied by one hand only. Each cut shall be made in one “bite” without splintering the wood or breaking, bending, or showing signs of distortion or damage to any part of the shears.

3.11 Identification marking. The items shall be marked with the manufacturer’s name or trademark. The use of an adhesive-backed label shall be acceptable.

3.12 Workmanship. The shears shall be free from defects which may impair the serviceability, durability or appearance of the shears. The shears shall be smoothly finished, true to shape, and show no evidence of misalignment. The operation or handling of the shears shall not be injurious to personnel.

3.13 Metric Products. products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within tolerances specified and all other requirements of this document are met. If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch-pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

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3.14 Standard commercial product. The items shall, as a minimum, be in accordance with the requirements of this CID and shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial product. A standard commercial product is a product which has been sold or is currently offered for sale on the commercial market through advertisements, manufacturer's catalogs or brochures, and represents the latest production model.

4. REGULATORY REQUIREMENTS

4.1 Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable, in accordance with paragraph 23. 403 of the Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR).

5. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

5.1 Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify and maintain substantiating evidence that the product offered meets the salient characteristics this Commercial Item Description, and that the product conforms to the producer's own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices, and is the same product offered for sale in the commercial marketplace. The government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to the first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

6. PACKAGING

6.1 Preservation, packing, and marking. Preservation, packing, and marking shall be as specified in the contract or order.

7. NOTES

7.1 Sources of non-Government association documents.

ASTM standards are available from the American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) ,1916 Race Street, Philadelphia, PA 19103.

7.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein and include the following information in procurement documents (if applicable) .

. Title, number, and date of this commercial item description.
b. Type required.
c. Preservation, packing, and marking required.

7.3 Figures. The figures shown herein are descriptive and not restrictive, and not intended to preclude the purchase of items which are otherwise in accordance with the requirements of this commercial item description.

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7.4 National Stock Numbers (NSN's): The following is a list of NSN's assigned which correspond to this commercial item description. This list may not be indicative of all possible NSN's.

NSN	Type	Nomenclature
3750-00-641-5587	I	Pruning shears
3750-00-494-1862	II	Pruning shears

MILITARY INTERESTS:

PREPARING ACTIVITY:
GSA - 7FXEE

Custodian
Air Force - 99

Review Activity
Air Force - 84

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